(R1.68_) MEDICAL SKID (GSMS): On still-developing colony worlds, competent medical assistance was usually in short supply, and actual doctors were rarer still. While general cargo was typically the freighter captain's bread, his or her butter could often be specialty services that were difficult to come by. After all, anyone can haul plasma conduit from one place to another.

A medical skid allows a freighter to provide basic (and even some moderately-advanced) medical services to (paying) customers in places where there are few (if any) alternatives. Rarely staffed with highly experienced medical personnel, they would often rely on sophisticated medical expert systems to assist with diagnosis and treatment plans.

A typical skid of this type would increase the freighter's BPV by six. The skid also adds a single crew unit (representing the "medical staff", who spent most of their time collecting payments and dispensing prescriptions, and who usually left the "medical" portion of the work to the computer). The healthcare facilities of the skid were often spartan, but usually better than those on many frontier planets.

Some variations have a small shuttle bay, into which a standard administrative shuttle was shoehorned, instead of the transporter. These would increase the BPV of the freighter by seven but otherwise are identical to the typical skid.

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